Social science - I

STD-9 Chapter-3

Land Grants and the Indian Society

Define 'Land Grants'

-The transfer of some of the land in the king's possession to the Brahmins along with special rights. This is known as 'Land Grants'.

What is the purpose of land grants by the king?

-To please the Brahmins who were dominant in the society.

List out the dynasties came to power in different parts of India after the fall of the Maurya's

-Kushanas
-Guptas
-Shakas
-Vakatakas
-Satavahanas
-Cholas
-Cheras
-Pandyas

When did the practice of land grants start?

-The land grants can be found in Buddhist period.
-But, it was only during the post- Mauryan period that it became widespread and also produced far-reaching consequences.
-the Satavahanas who ruled the Deccan region, started the practice of giving land grants to please the Brahmins who were dominant in the society.
-This system became wide-spread under the Guptas who came to power in Padaliputra by the beginning of the 4th century CE.

What are the changes brought about by the land grants during the Gupta period.

-The king's authority over the donated land gradually declined.
-The right to collect taxes and administer justice over the donated land was transferred along with the ownership of land.
-Those who received the land grants also got the right to grant the land to someone else.
-In course of time, the kings and nobles began to give land grants instead of cash as remuneration for the services they received.
-Although most of the land grants were received by the Brahmins, gradually, other sections also started receiving land as grant.

Indian Feudalism

-With the widespread practice of land grants, a powerful section of the landowners with immense wealth and influence was formed in the society.
-Those who worked on the land became right less dependents of the landlords.
-In such a system, the farmers, the agricultural labourers and the slaves were bound to the land.
-They lived and died in the same soil where they were born.
-They laboured throughout their life for their masters.

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-In addition to taxes, these people from the lower stratum of the society had to provide free services to the upper stratum.
-This system has been called ‘Indian Feudalism’.
-During this period, there was a remarkable improvement in the agriculture sector.

Factors that helped the spread of agriculture during Guptha period.
-Even the uncultivated areas were made suitable for agriculture
-The new social system provide sufficient labour force for agriculture
-The knowledge of Brahmins about agricultural technology and climate
-Different irrigation facilities

Irrigation methods that helped the expansion of Agriculture Irrigation facilities during the Gupta period
-Canals
-Tank/ Water Reservoir
-Ghatiyantra (Araghata)
-Rainwater
-Ghatiyantra (Araghata)
-Dams

Canals
-Water raised from wells reached farmland through channels

Tank/ Water Reservoir
-Rainwater was collected and used for agriculture
-Water reservoirs were built in South India
-Tanks were constructed in North India.

Ghatiyantra (Araghata)
-Pots are attached to a wheel.
-When the wheel is rotated the pots are filed from the source and emptied into the field

Dams
-Skandagupta rebuilt the Sudarsana Lake in Gujarat

Crafts and Trade during Guptha period.
-Expansion of agriculture that resulted from land grants led to the growth of non-agricultural activities too.
-People took to different crafts in order to make a living.
-The literary works and artefacts of this period give us information regarding the crafts of the period.
-People engaged in the same craft gradually formed associations.
-These came to be called ‘Guilds’ or ‘Srenis’.
-Governments ratified the ‘Srenis’.
-Members of a ‘Sreni’ had to abide by its rules.
Find out the arts and crafts of the Guptha period from the information and complete the table.

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Artifacts Recovered	Crafts
-Earthen Pots	-Pottery making
-Jewellery made of gold, silver and precious stones	-Ornament making
-Pearls	-Pearl making
-Glassware	-Glassware production
-Silk, cotton textiles	-Silk, cotton textiles production
-Sculptures in ivory	-Ivory sculpture production

Srenis and its aims / functions.
-'Srenis' were associations of craftsmen and traders.
-Collecting raw-materials, controlling production and marketing the finished goods were their responsibilities.

Trade and Commerce in Gupta rule.
-Internal trade flourished during the initial year of Gupta rule.
-Various crafts existed along with agriculture.
-Such products made by the skilled craftsmen were the chief items of trade.
-Textiles was one of the most traded products.
-Different types of textiles (muslin, calico, linen) were manufactured on a large scale.
-They had external trade links with West Asia, Central Asia, South East Asia, and Rome.
-New trade routes developed during the period.
-Gold, silver and copper coins of high quality were minted.
-Prominent traders known as 'Nagarasreshtin' and 'Sarthvaha' had their on role in the government.
-Vaishali, Pataliputra, Kanauj, Shravasti, Kausambi, Ujjayini and Mathura were important centres of trade.

In which present Indian states are the Gupta cities located.
-Kanauj -Uthar Pradesh
-Shravasti -Uthar Pradesh
-Mathura -Uthar Pradesh
-Kausambi -Uthar Pradesh
-Vaishali -Bihar
-Pataliputra -Bihar
-Ujjayini -Madyapradesh

Reasons for the decline of foreign trade during Gupta period?
-Collapse of the Roman Empire by the 6 th century CE.
-Westerners had learned the technique of silk-making from the Chinese.

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Effect of the decline of foreign trade during Gupta period?
-Collapse of the Roman Empire by the 6th century CE.
-Decline of foreign trade adversely affected the internal trade also.
-There was a dip in the movement of the craftsmen and artisans to different parts of the country for trade purposes.
-They confined themselves to their villages.
-This led to the ruralisation of arts and crafts.
-The slump in trade, the general decline in crafts and ruralisation led to the decay of many major towns.

Social Life during Gupta period?
-We have already discussed the various occupational groups (Srenis) that were formed in the Gupta period.
-The entry of new occupational groups and the coming of new peoples led to the formation of a number of sub-divisions in the society.
-It was impossible for the existing varna system to accommodate all these new occupational groups.
-In this circumstance, each occupational group became a new ‘jati’ or ‘upajati’.

Position and privileges of the Brahmins, Kshatriyas, Vaisyas and Sudras in the new complex caste system that evolved during Gupta period.
-No change in the position and privileges of the Brahmins, Kshatriyas and Vaisyas in the new complex system.
-The Chinese traveller Hiuen Tsang who visited India in the seventh century described Sudras as peasants.
-These descriptions indicate the social status of the Sudras in an agricultural society.

The ‘Antyajas’
-The ‘Antyajas’ who were outside the Chaturvarnya system were considered ‘untouchables’.
-Accordingly, the lowest among the ‘Antyajas’ were the graveyard keepers called ‘Chandalas’ and the animal skin tanners called ‘Charmakarar’.

Position of Women during the Gupta period.
-Women had a low status in society.
-Only a few queens like Prabhavathi Gupta of Vakadaka dynasty were held in high esteem.
-All women, from queens to the women of the lowest section in the society, were expected to be submissive to men.
-Even the upper-class women did not enjoy a high position or consideration in the society.
-There is no evidence of land grants received by even a Brahmin woman.

Write down the about the powers of the king during the Gupta period?
-The king was considered equal to God
-The king was rich
-The king was strong
-The king was a great warrior

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Responsibilities of the Gupta kings?

-Protect the people from aggressions
-Protect Brahmin, Sramanas (Budhist / Jain monks) and the weaker sections
-Administration of justice
-The Guptas allowed the rulers of the territories they conquered to continue as 'Samanthas' of the Gupta kingdom.
-They were given autonomy in their respective areas.
-The Guptas did not interfere in their matters of administration or succession.
-But they developed an elaborate administrative system in the areas where they ruled directly.

Prepare a short note comparing the administrative sistem of the Mauryas and the Guptas.

Mauryas	Guptas
-Amatya - by the king Appointed	-Minister - The position is inherited
-Salary to officers paid in cash	-Right to collect land tax in lieu of salary
-Detailed calculation to determine tax	-No detailed calculation to determine tax
-Monetary system is strong	-Monetary system is weak

Features of Temples Constructed by Guptas

-Construction of temples using stone and bricks.
-Temples were also built by digging rocks.
-Painting were done on the walls
-Carved painting were also done.

What are the features of world famous paintings of the Ajanta Caves (Maharashtra)

-The world famous paintings of the Ajanta Caves (Maharashtra) belong to the Gupta period.
-These paintings depict royal life, royal court and celestial beings.
-Scenes from the Ramayana and the Mahabharata also became themes of these paintings.
-Natural colours were used to paint these pictures that have survived several centuries and still remain graceful.

Sanskrit literature during Gupta period

-Sanskrit literature received royal patronage during the Gupta period.
-Sanskrit was the language of administration.
-Even the Buddhist who had been using common languages like Pali started writing in Sanskrit.
-The Ramayana, the Mahabharata and most of the Puranas were codified in written language (or oral to written) and converted into the present textual form during this period.

Dramas, poems, Grammar, and Lexicon were composed in Sanskrit during the Gupta period.

Name of the Text	Author	Genre of Literature
Abhijnana Sakunthala	Kalidasa	Drama
Kumarasambhava	Kalidasa	Poem
Mriccha Katika	Sudraka	Drama

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Swapnavasavadattha	Bhasa	Drama
Thrikandi	Bhartrhari	Grammar
Amarakosam	Amarasimha	Lexicon

Languages spoken by the characters when the Sanskrit drama was performed on the stage.
-Only the so called upper caste male characters spoke in Sanskrit.
-Women characters including the queen, and male characters belonging to castes considered lower used only Prakrit language.

Six system of philosophy
-It laid the foundation for Indian philosophy.
-It formulate during the period of Guptha rule.
-It took shape through mutual debates.

Six system of philosophy-philosophies and their proponents

Philosophy	Exponent
Samkhya (statistics)	Kapila
Yoga	Patanjali
Nyaya(നീതി നിയമങ്ങള്)	Gauthama
Vaisheshika(അണുസിദ്ധാന്തം)	Kanada
Vedanta (വേദങ്ങളുടെ ഉപസംഹാരം)	Badarayana
Mimamsa(ആഴത്തിലുള്ള അന്വേഷണം)	Jaimini

Development of science during the Gupta period.
-Many books on science also were written during the Gupta period.
-Most of the works were on Astronomy, Mathematics, and Medical Science.
-Notable works of the period were:
Brihatsamhita - Varahamihira,
Aryabhatiya - Arya Bhata,
Amarakosa - Amarasimha.
-Metallurgy -The iron pillar situated at Mehrauli near Delhi is an excellent example for the technological skills achieved in metallurgy during that period.

Land grants in South India
-The practice of land grants spread to South India by the 6 th century CE.
-This was due to the migration of Brahmins from North India to South India.
-The Pallavas and Pandyas were the important dynasties of South India during the period.
-They granted lands to Brahmins and temples.
-As a result, the Brahmins attained high status in the South Indian society and economy.
-Granting of land to the Brahmins led to the development of agriculture in this area.
-The Brahmins' knowledge of agricultural technology and climate helped the expansion of agriculture.
-Kings and local administrative bodies encouraged agriculture by building reservoirs and maintaining irrigation facilities.

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Progress in agricultural and trade in Pallava Kingdom

-Due to the activities of the temples controlled by the Brahmins there was agricultural progress in Pallava Kingdom
-Surplus production in agriculture led to the progress of trade.
-Maritime trade flourished along with internal trade.
-Mahabalipuram was a busy port under the Pallavas.
-Nagapattanam was an another port of trade.

Famous Pallava Kings

-Simhavishnu - Founder of Pallava Kingdom
-Mahendravarman I - Wrote Mathavilasam
-Narasimhavarman I – Completed temples were built at Mamallapuram.
-Narasimhavarman II – Built many structures including Shore Temple and Kailasanatha temple.
-Nandivarman III – Emphasize navy and trade.

Features of the Pandyan trade

-Merchant guilds were the features of Pandyan trade.
-The merchant guilds which were known as 'Srenis' in North India came to be called as ‘Vanika’ communities in South India.
-Each guild specialised in the trade of a particular product.
-’Nagarattar’ were traders.
-Pepper, sandal, gold and pearls were the chief items of export from the Pandyan Kingdom.
-The Pandyans traded with the Rome, Greek, Chinese And Arab merchants through the ports Korkai, Kayal Pattanam and Periya Pattanam.

Revenue source of Pallava and Pandya kingdom.

-Expansion of agriculture, growth of trade, and a variety of crafts become the source of revenue to the Pallava and Pandya kingdom.
-Land tax was the chief source of income.
-People had to pay 1\10 to 1\6 of the produce as land tax.
-Those engaged in different crafts had to pay taxes.
-The *Brahmadeya* land granted to temples and the *Agraharas* (Brahmin villages) were exempted from land tax.

Brahmaswam or Brahmadeya

-Land granted to a group of Brahmins was called Brahmadeya.

Agrahara

-Brahmin villages were called agraharas

Devaswam or Devadanam

-Land gifted to the Deity or the Temple came to be called Devadanam.
-This land was administered by the temple trustees.

Social and cultural life of South India.

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-The Pallava and Pandya society were based on cast system.
-The Brahmins who received large extents of land as Brahmadeya were wealthy and they had a dominant status in society.
-Low castes suffered many hardships.
-There was village autonomy in Pallava and Pandya kindom.
-Village courts also existed.
-Education, justice, etc. were administered and disputes were discussed and settled through collective opinion.
-The Kings did not interfere in such matters.
-They did not interfere in the customs, practices of worship or caste rules.

Religious believes During Pallava and Pandya
-Jainism and Buddism were flourishing in South India before Pallava period.
-But these religions declined with the increased power of Brahmins.
-Pallavas and Pandyas build Saiva-Vaishnava temples and encouraged the Bhakti movement.

Literary works of south India during Pallava period
-Ideas of Brahmanical religion and bhakthi were reflected well.
-Pallavas encouraged Sanskrit literature.
-The Pallavas king Mahendravarma I was a Sanskrit scholar.
-Matthavilasa Prahasana was written by him.

Important temples in south India during Pallava and Pandya period.
-Temples of south India had a considerable influence on the life of the people at that time.
-Temples were the chief works of art of that period.
-Important temples of the period are situated in Kanchipuram, Mahabalipuram and Madurai.
-South Indian style of temple construction known as ‘Dravidian style’ evolved during the period of Pallavas.

Three phase of temple construction developed during Pallava period.
-Rock-cut temples
-Monolithic chariot temples
- Structuraltemples

Dravidian Architecture
-Temple building was there in India from ancient times.
-There were three styles of temple architecture. -‘Nagara’ and
‘Vasara’ styles were followed in North India.
'Dravidian' style prevailed in South India.
-Huge mandapas was the chief characteristic of Dravidian architecture.

Dravidian Architecture.
-Huge mandapas was the chief characteristic of Dravidian architecture.
-Pallavas were the first to prove excellence in Dravidian Architecture.
-Temples at Mahabaliputam are the finest examples of their excellence in temple building.
-At the same time, the largest number of temples in the Dravidian style were built by the Cholas.
-Temples built by them during that period still exist in different parts of Tamil Nadu.
-The Meenakshi temple at Madurai and the Srirangam temple are the famous constructions of the Pandyas.

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Specific features of Dravidian temples.

-Temples made in Dravidian style of architect have certain specific features.
-They are, ‘Sreekovil’ or ‘Garbhagriha’ (Sanctum Sanctorum), ‘Vimana’ (the top portion of the temple building), ‘Sikhara’ (the top of the Vimana) Mandapa Pradhakshina patha (path forcircumambulation).
-Gigantic entrance gateways, tall 'gopuras', (towers), carved elephants, horses, and dragon faces in decorative styles are the characteristic features of the Dravidian style.
-Characters from Itihasas and Puranas have been carved on the walls of these temples with great care and extraordinary skill.

Mahabalipuram

-The most notable temples and stone-crved figures of this period can be seen at Mahabalipuram in Tamil Nadu.
-This place, also known as Mamallapuram, is situated on the shores of the Bay of Bengal.
-The five monolithic Ratha Temples representing the five Pandavas and Draupati.
-The Shore Temple built on the sea shore are the finest examples of Pallava architecture.
-The rock carved figures called ‘Arjuna Penance’ and ‘Mahishasura Mardana’ are example of Pallava art.
-UNESCO has declared Mahabalipuram as a heritage city.

All the Best

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